

IN THE HIGH COURT OF JUDICATURE AT BOMBAY

Cascade Textiles Mills Ltd. vs Naveen Chandra & Ors. ... on 25 April, 2022
(2022) 9 ALD 176, AIR 2023 SC 105
Bench: Sunita Agarwal, J. and D.Y. Chandrachud, J.

JUDGMENT

Sunita Agarwal, J.

1. This appeal arises out of a civil suit for Specific Performance of an Agreement to Sell registered under the Indian Registration Act, 1908. The plaintiff/appellant seeks execution of sale deed and permanent injunction under Order 39 Rule 1 and 2 of the Code of Civil Procedure, 1908 (CPC) in respect of property situated in Jaipur.
2. The respondent/vendor contended that time was of the essence and the appellant failed to tender the balance consideration of Rs. 1.8 Crores within the stipulated 90 days, invoking forfeiture under Section 74 of the Indian Contract Act, 1872.
3. Mr. Dave, learned Senior Counsel for the appellant, argued that in contracts relating to immovable property time is not ordinarily of the essence, and demonstrated continuous readiness and willingness under Section 16(c) of the Specific Relief Act, 1963.
4. Counsel relied upon (1993) 1 SCC 519 in the case of Chand Rani v. Kamal Rani, and upon (2020) 13 SCC 285 in the case of Sughar Singh v. Hari Singh, holding readiness and willingness must be gathered from contemporaneous conduct.
5. Having examined the bank statements and escrow deposits, this Court holds the appellant satisfied the test of readiness and willingness under Section 16(c) of the Specific Relief Act, 1963.
6. The appeal is allowed. The respondents are directed to execute the conveyance deed upon receipt of the remaining consideration within eight weeks.

D.Y. Chandrachud, J. - I agree.